

The Importance of Open Source in the Metaverse

The Metaverse is no longer fiction...this virtual world is set to take over our lives, making people all over the globe connect with each other in ways never experienced before. But how relevant or important is the role of open source in this new virtual world? That is the question this article attempts to answer.

The Metaverse has four pillars, namely, virtual spaces, virtual assets, virtual interactions and digital payments. In this new virtual world, co-workers or students can gather for a chat over coffee irrespective of what part of the globe they belong to. Musicians or artists can also interact with fans from around the world in a large digital venue, which would be impossible in the physical world. Today, conferences

can reach new audiences unlike before. All this can be achieved due to 5G, augmented reality (AR), virtual reality (VR), and edge computing. These ultra-reliable, low latency services ensure the rendering of 3D graphics and content, and make virtual experiences faster. "Open source will play a huge role in the Metaverse, and will help it evolve faster," says Dr Lokesh Boregowda, director, Samsung R&D Institute India.

